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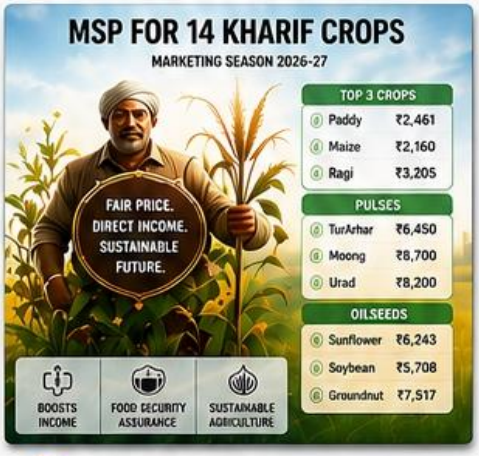


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India assumes Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time; appoints Vivek Agrawal

In June 2025, India was elected as Vice-President of the Financial Task Force (FATF) for the first time. This reflects India's commitment to global standards in combating money laundering and terrorist financing.

Exam Hint:

- **What:** Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time
- **Who:** Vivek Agrawal
- **Body:** Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
- **Term:** July 2025 to June 2027
- **Significance:** Helps build trust and recognition.

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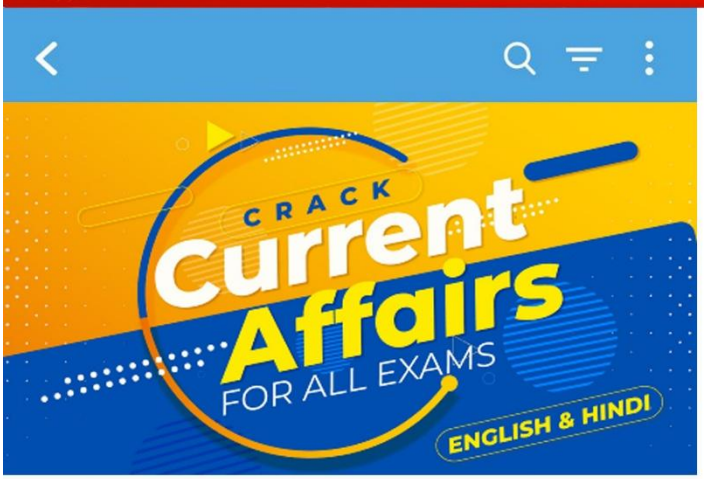
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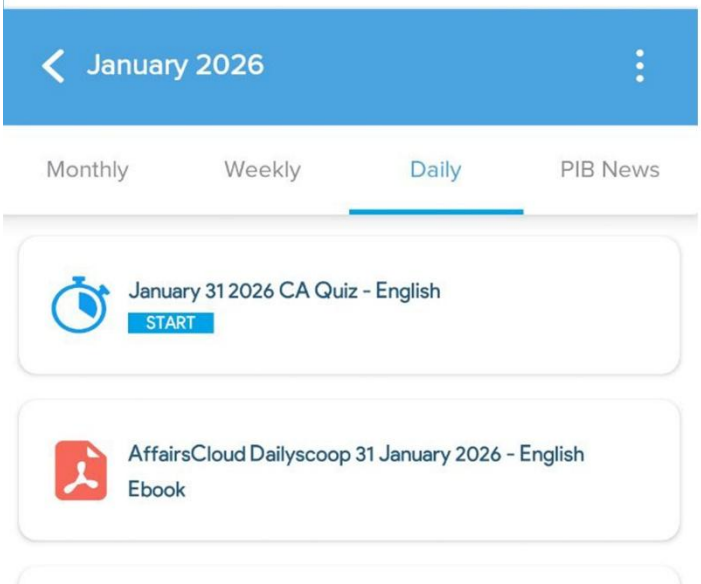
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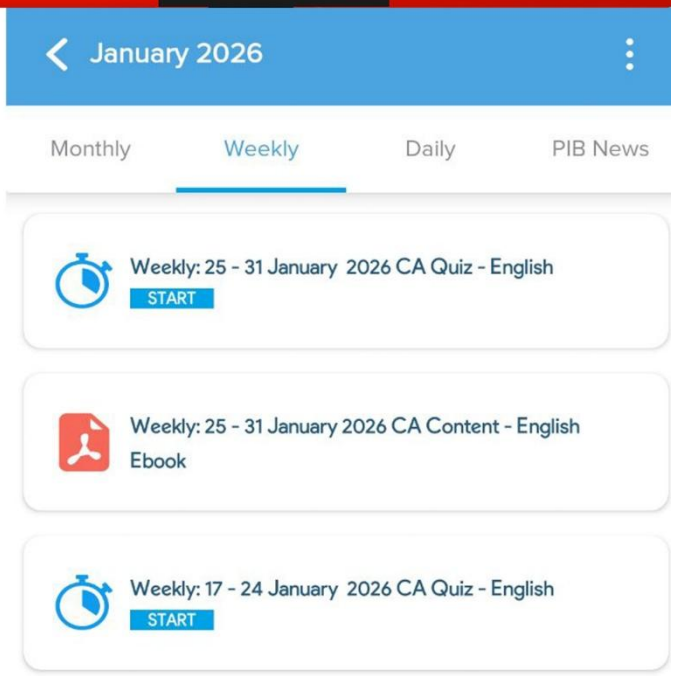
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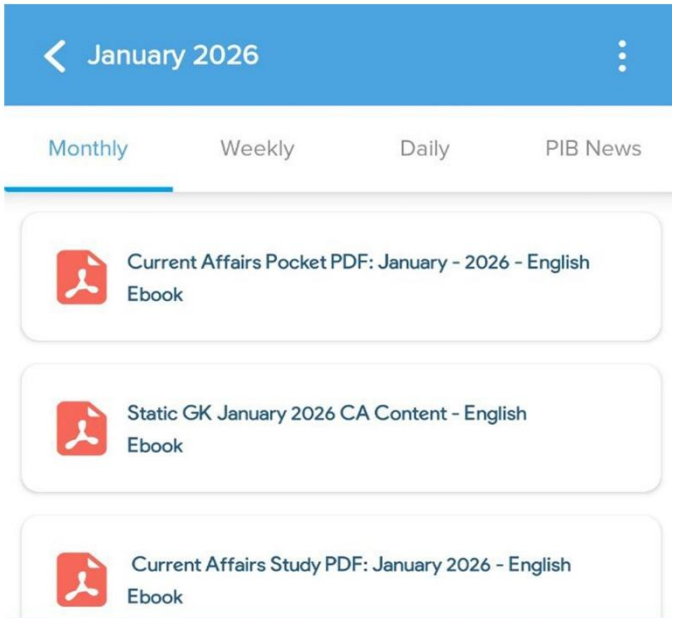
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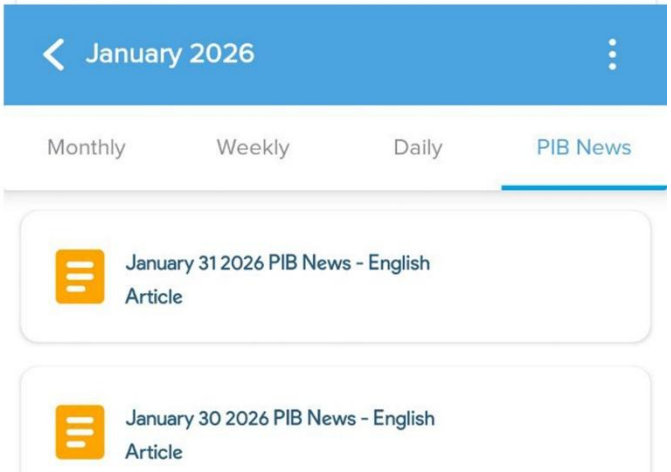
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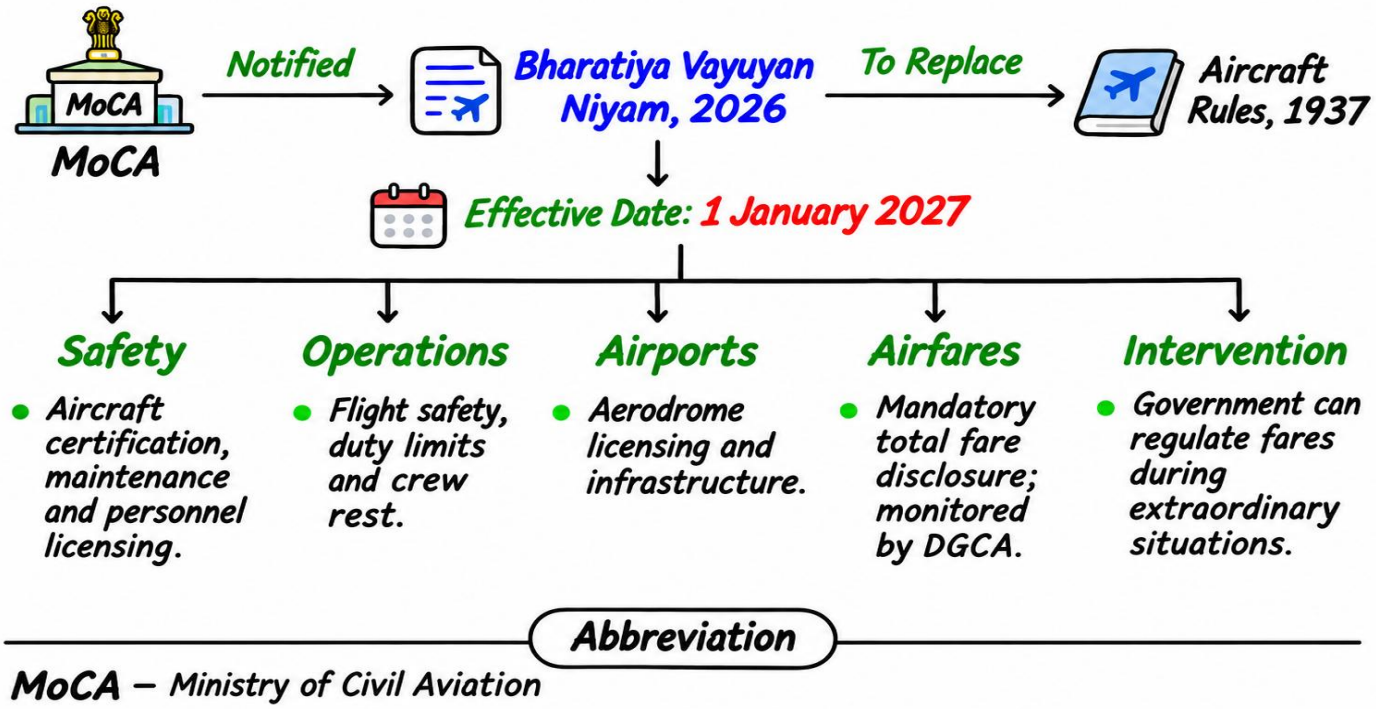
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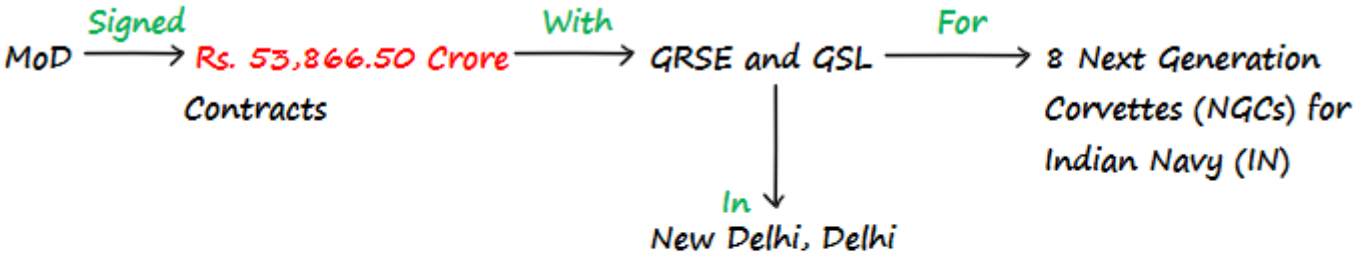
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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)



2)

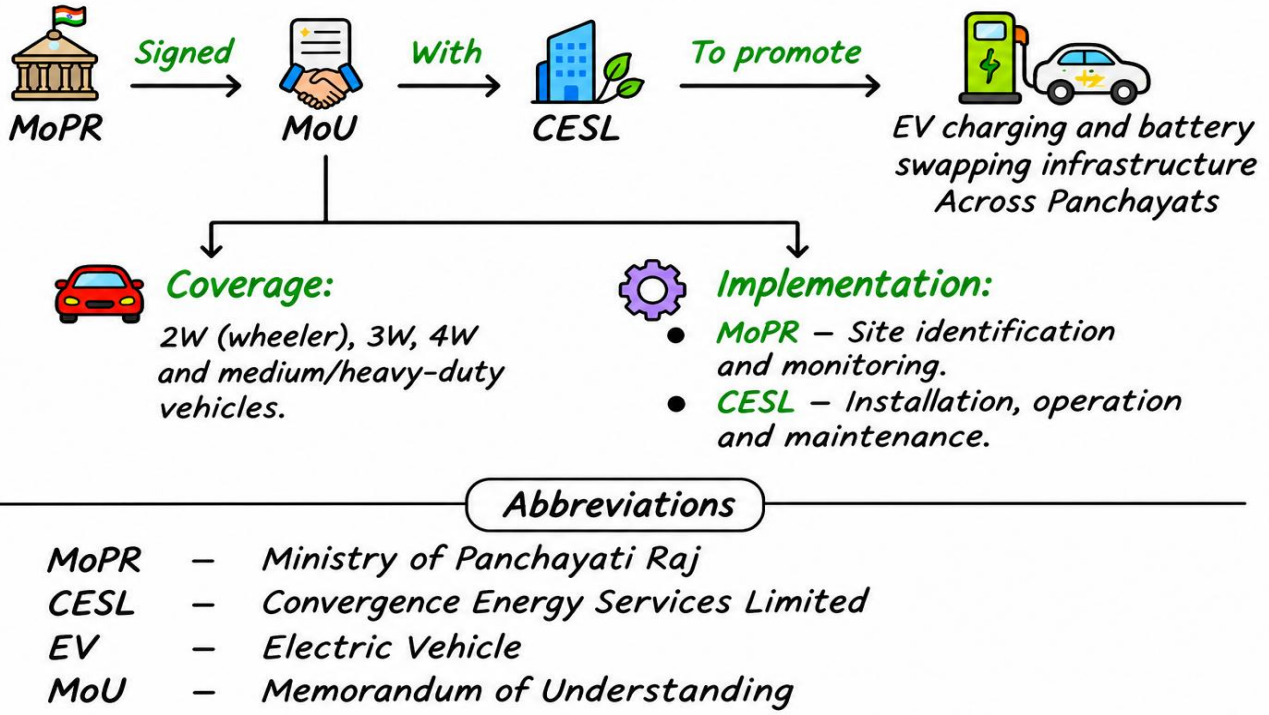


Construction: GRSE – 5 corvettes; GSL – 3 corvettes.
IN Design: Indian Navy-designed warships, built by DPSUs.
Displacement: 3,800–4,000 tonnes.

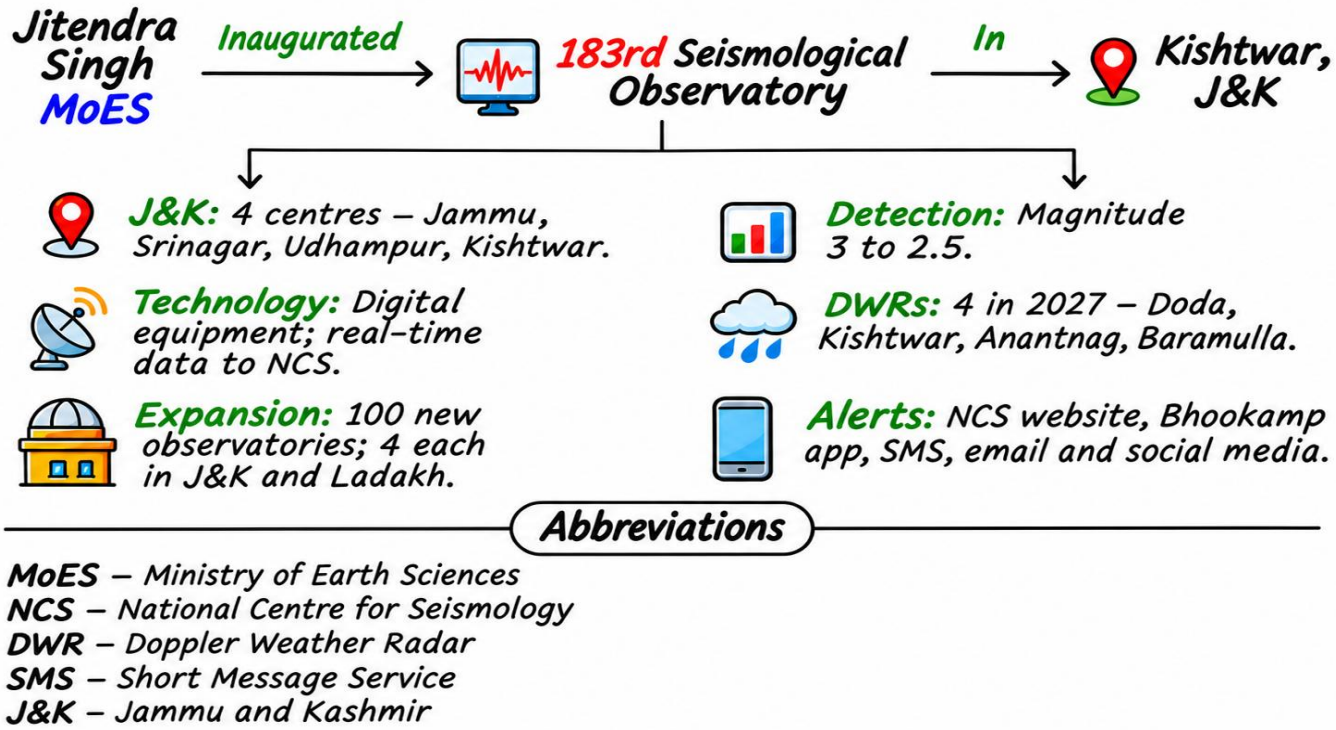
MoD – Ministry of Defence
GRSE – Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
GSL – Goa Shipyard Limited
DPSU – Defence Public Sector Undertaking

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3)



4)



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5)

Rajiv Ranjan Singh (MoFAH&D and MoPR) —Announced→ CoE —For→ Siri Cattle Conservation & development —In→ Sikkim

- Technology: IVF for genetic improvement.
- Dairy: NDMU launched under White Revolution 2.0.
- Conservation: Indigenous bovine breed preservation programme launched.
- Pig Breeding: Semen production and artificial insemination protocols released.

CoE – Centre of Excellence

IVF – In Vitro Fertilisation

NDMU – North District Cooperative Milk Producers' Union

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

Overview of CoP17 —To→ United Nations (UN) CBD —Held at→ Armenia —Under theme→ "Taking Action for Nature."

→ About COP17:

- Decisions: Nearly 50 decisions adopted.
- Logo: Eriwan Blue butterfly; 23 colours representing 23 KMGBF targets.
- Parallel Meetings: CP-MOP12 and NP-MOP6.
- EC Next COP: Quito, Ecuador (2028).

→ India at COP17:

- IN Delegation: Led by Union Minister Bhupender Yadav (MoEFCC).
- NBSAP: 23 national targets and 142 indicators.
- Protected Areas: 1,134; Ramsar Sites – 103; BHS – 57; BRs – 18 (13 under UNESCO-MAB).
- 4 Publications: I-OECM Guidelines 2026; 5th National Report on Cartagena Protocol; CBD Handbook: India's ABS Success Story.
- Side Event: Organised by MoEFCC with NBA and UNDP on biodiversity commitments through innovation, finance, ABS and OECMs.

→ Key Outcomes:

- Yerevan Pathway: KMGBF implementation by 2030.
- Funding Target: USD 200 billion annually; USD 30 billion international finance.
- New Funding: USD 2 billion (GEF – 560 million; Species Recovery Alliance – 500 million; Value Nature Fund – 330 million+).
- Decisions: 50 on forests, wildlife, invasive species, marine biodiversity

→ About COP to CBD:

- Established: CBD adopted in 1992; focuses on conservation
- Meetings: Biennial (every 2 years).

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COP – Conference of the Parties
CBD – Convention on Biological Diversity
KMGBF – Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework
MoEFCC – Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
BHS – Biodiversity Heritage Sites
BR – Biosphere Reserve
MAB – Man and the Biosphere
GEF – Global Environment Facility
NBA – National Biodiversity Authority
UNDP – United Nations Development Programme
ABS – Access and Benefit Sharing
FAO – Food and Agriculture Organization
I-OECM – India's Other Effective Area-Based Conservation Measures

2)

20th ADMM & 13th ADMM-Plus —Chaired by→ Gilberto C. Teodoro Jr. (Secretary of DND) —On→ 28–29 October 2026 —At→ Mactan Expo Center, Cebu, Philippines

Theme: "Navigating Our Future, Together"

India's Participation
- Represented by: Union Minister Rajnath Singh (MoD)
- Proposed: India–ASEAN Youth Bridge
- Objective: Digital innovation, youth connectivity & defence cooperation
- Counter-Terrorism EWG: India & Malaysia (2024–2027)

Key Outcomes
- Joint Statement: Youth, Peace and Security
- Commemoration: 50th Anniversary of TAC
- Next Host (2027): Singapore
- Next Chair: Chan Chun Sing
- Upcoming: 21st ADMM & 14th ADMM-Plus

ASEAN – Association of Southeast Asian Nations
ADMM – ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting
DND – Department of National Defense
MoD – Ministry of Defence
EWG – Experts' Working Group
TAC – Treaty of Amity and Cooperation

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BANKING & FINANCE

1)

SEBI —Issued→ Framework —To Issue→ DRs of REITs and InvITs at GIFT & City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

Reduces OFS Cooling-off period to 8 weeks from 12 weeks

REITs and InvITs DRs Issuance:

- Exchanges: India INX and NSE IX.
- Approval: 75% unitholder votes.
- Tender: Equal offer to existing unitholders.
- Restriction: Indian residents barred from holding DRs.
- Eligibility: No debarment or wilful default.
- Disclosure: Within 24 hours; private InvIT DRs for foreign institutions and corporates.
- Merchant Banker: Mandatory appointment.

Cooling Off Period Reduced:

- OFS: reduced for illiquid private listed InvITs.
- Reason: Low liquidity, high lot sizes.
- Exemption: Retail OFS rules not applicable.

SEBI – Securities and Exchange Board of India
REIT – Real Estate Investment Trust
InvIT – Infrastructure Investment Trust
DR – Depository Receipt
GIFT – Gujarat International Finance Tec-City
OFS – Offer for Sale

2)

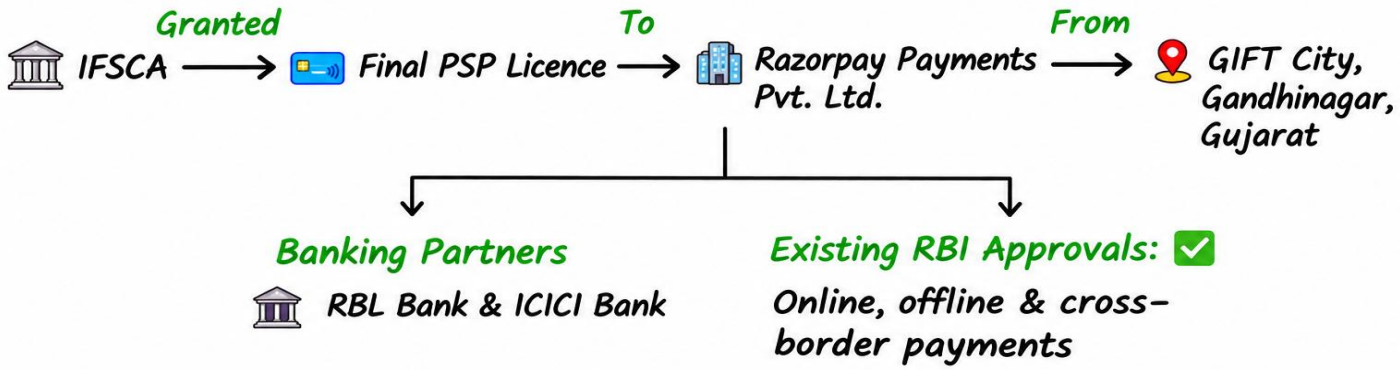
Fibe Digital lending Platform —launched→ UPI-Payments —After→ NPCI Grants TPAP approval

- Access: Available to all users, including non-borrowers.
- Features: Bank account payments, RuPay credit cards and eligible credit lines.

UPI – Unified Payments Interface
NPCI – National Payments Corporation of India
TPAP – Third-Party Application Provider

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3)



Abbreviations

PSP	–	Payment Service Provider
IFSCA	–	International Financial Services Centres Authority
GIFT City	–	Gujarat International Finance Tec-City
RBI	–	Reserve Bank of India

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

1)



10 top performers scored above 93%

📊 Assessment: Mines are assessed on 84 parameters covering safety, efficiency, technology, environment and workers' welfare; scores above 91/100 qualify for Five-Star Ratings.

⛏️ Opencast: NCL India and NTPC secured First Prize.
🏅 Underground: SCCL won First Prize for five mines across its operational areas.
🌟 Appreciation: WCL recorded the highest number of Five-Star Rated mines among CIL subsidiaries.
📈 Performance: NCL and MCL were recognised for consistent performance in Star Rating evaluations and production.

💡 Hackathon: During the event, winners of the "NextGen AI for Smart Mining" Hackathon 2026 received Rs. 4 lakh, Rs. 3 lakh and Rs. 2 lakh, respectively.

FY - Financial Year

NTPC – National Thermal Power Corporation

SCCL – Singareni Collieries Company Limited

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WCL – Western Coalfields Limited
CIL – Coal India Limited
MCL – Mahanadi Coalfields Limited

ACQUISITIONS & MERGERS

1)

Competition Commission of India (CCI) —Approved→ Five major transactions
Five major transactions —Across→
- 🍔 Food services: Approved Sapphire Foods–Devyani merger, combining KFC and Pizza Hut businesses.
- 🌞 Renewable energy: Cleared Aditya Birla Renewables' acquisition of Solenergi Power from Shell for Rs. 17,200 crore.
- ⚡ Power infrastructure: Approved Adani Energy Solutions' acquisition of IntelliSmart for Rs. 3,050 crore.
- 💳 Financial services: Approved Prosus' MIH Payments acquiring a stake in Navi Limited
- 📱 Telecommunications: Approved France-based Vega SAS acquiring a 16.2% stake in Vodafone Group PLC.

SPORTS

1)

Mexico City Grand Prix 2026 —Held→ Mexico —On→ 1 November 2026

19th round of the 2026 F1 World Championship (23 total rounds)

Top 3 at Mexico City Grand Prix 2026

Rank	Driver	Brand
1	Max Verstappen (Netherlands)	Red Bull Racing
2	Lewis Hamilton (UK)	Ferrari
3	Andrea Kimi Antonelli (Italy)	Mercedes

- 🥇 Champion: Andrea Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes) clinched his maiden F1 World Drivers' Championship at 20 years and 68 days, becoming the youngest-ever champion with 380 points
- 📊 Championship Standings: Antonelli (380), Verstappen (261), Hamilton (259), George Russell (250) and Charles Leclerc (245)

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F1 – Formula One

UK – United Kingdom

2)

Hylo Open 2026 (BWF Super 500 tournament) —Held→ Saarbrücken, Germany —On→ 27 October – 1 November 2026

Winners at Hylo Open 2026:

Category	Winner(s)	Runner(s)-up
Men's Singles	Lakshya Sen (India)	Jonatan Christie (Indonesia)
Women's Singles	P. V. Sindhu (India)	Line Højmark Kjærsfeldt (Denmark)
Men's Doubles	Christian Faust Kjær / Rasmus Kjær (Denmark)	Ben Lane / Sean Vendy (England)
Women's Doubles	Amallia Cahaya Pratiwi / Siti Fadia Silva Ramadhanti (Indonesia)	Hsu Yin-Hui / Lin Jhih Yun (Chinese Taipei)
Mixed Doubles	Thom Gicquel / Delphine Delrue (France)	Jesper Toft / Amalie Cecilie Kudsk (Denmark)

🌟 Milestones: Sindhu secured her second BWF World Tour title of 2026 and seventh career title; Sen claimed his first BWF World Tour title of 2026.

💰 Prize Money: Total prize pool of USD 500,000; singles champions received USD 37,500 and doubles champions USD 39,500.

BWF – Badminton World Federation

3)

Glenn Maxwell (Australian all-rounder) —Announced→ Retirement —From→ International Cricket —After→ 14-year career

Retirement —Continues→ Playing franchise T20 cricket for Melbourne Stars in the Big Bash League (BBL)

📊 Career Stats: ODIs – 3,990 runs; T20Is – 2,897 runs, 51 wickets; Tests – 339 runs.

🌍 World Cups: Titles in 2015, 2021 and 2023; unbeaten 201 in 2023.

🏅 Titles: 4 Sheffield Shield, IPL 2013, MLC 2024 and County Championship 2015.

🎖️ Player of the Year Awards: ODI (2016), T20I (2016, 2019) and BBL (2024-25).

T20 – Twenty20

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ODI – One-Day International

T20I – Twenty20 International

MLC – Major League Cricket

OBITUARY

1)

Professor Dr. Ashok Kumar Mahapatra → Eminent Neurosurgeon and Padma Shri Awardee 2025, in the field of Medicine.

- Born: Odisha
- Passed away at 74: New Delhi, Delhi

- Other Award: C. V. Raman Award for Scientific Excellence (2022).
- Organisations: Founding President of NSSI and ISPNS (2011).
- Landmark Surgery: Led 16-hour separation of conjoined twins Jaga and Balia at AIIMS (2017).

AIIMS – All India Institute of Medical Sciences

NSSI – Neurological Surgeons Society of India

ISPNS – Indian Society of Peripheral Nerve Surgery

IMPORTANT DAYS

1)

3 November 2026 → UNESCO's 5th International Day for Biosphere Reserves → Promote Biodiversity conservation

- First Observance: 3 November 2022
- Programme: UNESCO launched the MAB Programme in 1971, governed by a 34-member MAB-ICC.

- IN India: 18 biosphere reserves covering 91,425 sq. km, with 13 recognised by UNESCO.
- First Reserve: Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve (1986), spanning TN, Kerala and Karnataka.
- Latest Inclusion: Cold Desert Biosphere Reserve joined WNBR in September 2025.
- Funding: Centre–State sharing ratio of 60:40 and 90:10 for North-Eastern and Himalayan States.
- Management: Five-year plans piloted in four biosphere reserves – Nanda Devi (Uttarakhand), Pachmarhi (MP), Dehang-Dibang (AR) and Agasthyamalai (Kerala–TN).

UNESCO – United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

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MAB – Man and the Biosphere

ICC - International Coordinating Council

WNBR – World Network of Biosphere Reserves

MP – Madhya Pradesh

AR – Arunachal Pradesh

TN – Tamil Nadu

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Detailed Content

Current Affairs 4 November 2026: Headlines



- MoCA Notifies Bharatiya Vayuyan Niyam, 2026 to Replace Aircraft Rules, 1937
- MoD Signs Rs. 53,866.50 Crore Contracts for Eight Next Generation Corvettes for Indian Navy
- MoPR Signs MoU with CESL to Promote EV Infrastructure Across Panchayats
- Union MoS Dr Jitendra Singh Inaugurates 183rd Seismological Observatory in Kishtwar, J&K
- Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh Announces CoE for for Siri Cattle Conservation in Sikkim
- Overview of COP17 to CBD Held from October 19 to 31, 2026 in Armenia
- Overview of 20th ADMM and 13th ADMM-Plus 2026 Held in Cebu, Philippines
- SEBI Issues Framework To Issue DRs of REITs and InvITs at GIFT City, Reduces OFS Cooling-off period
- Fibe Launches UPI Payments Segment after NPCI Grants TPAP Approval
- Razorpay Receives Final PSP Licence from IFSCA to Operate from GIFT City
- Ministry of Coal Presents Star Rating Awards for FY25, Recognising 50 Five-Star Coal and Lignite Mines in Raipur, Chhattisgarh
- CCI Approves Five Major Deals Across Food, Energy, Power, Fintech and Telecom Sectors
- Mexico City Grand Prix 2026: Verstappen Wins, Antonelli Clinches Maiden Title
- Indian shuttlers Lakshya Sen and PV Sindhu Win Singles Titles at HYLO Open 2026 in Germany
- Australian All-Rounder Glenn Maxwell Retires from International Cricket After 14-Year Career
- Eminent Neurosurgeon and Padma Shri Awardee Dr. Ashok Kumar Mahapatra Passed Away at 74
- International Day for Biosphere Reserves 2026 – November 3

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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

MoCA Notifies Bharatiya Vayuyan Niyam, 2026 to Replace Aircraft Rules, 1937

In October 2026, the Ministry of Civil Aviation **(MoCA)** notified the '**Bharatiya Vayuyan Niyam, 2026',** in the Gazette of India, replacing the nearly nine-decade-old A**ircraft Rules, 1937**, to modernise India's civil aviation regulatory framework.

- The new rules will come into effect on **1 January 2027,** introducing a consolidated regulatory framework for aircraft registration, safety certification, maintenance, flight operations, personnel licensing, airline tariffs and airport operations.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Bharatiya Vayuyan Niyam, 2026 notified
- ✓ **Notified by:** MoCA
- ✓ **Effective from:** 1 January 2027
- ✓ **Replace**: Aircraft Rules, 1937
- ✓ **Regulatory Authority:** DGCA
- ✓ **Fare Disclosure:** Airlines must disclose total ticket prices, including base fare, taxes, fees, cancellation charges and refund conditions.

Key Provisions of Bharatiya Vayuyan Niyam, 2026:

Framework: The rules are framed under the **Bharatiya Vayuyan Adhiniyam, 2024**, which establishes the regulatory framework for India's civil aviation sector.

Certification: It prescribes requirements for aircraft registration, airworthiness certification, design approval, manufacturing, modifications and repairs.

Maintenance: Mandates regular aircraft inspections and maintenance to ensure continued airworthiness and compliance with safety standards.

Licensing: Specifies qualification, training, examination, experience and medical fitness requirements for pilots, aircraft maintenance engineers and air traffic controllers, along with licence renewal, suspension and cancellation conditions.



Operations: Regulates flight planning, operational procedures, safety standards and flight and duty time limitations for pilots and cabin crew to prevent fatigue.

- It also prescribes **minimum crew rest periods** and covers aerodrome licensing, airport infrastructure and safety requirements.

Tariffs: Requires scheduled airlines to determine fares based on factors such as operating costs and submit tariff details to the Directorate General of Civil Aviation **(DGCA)** for monitoring.

- Airlines must publish fares on official websites and digital platforms and disclose the **total ticket price** during booking and on the booked ticket, including base fare, taxes, fees, cancellation charges and refund conditions. The rules also distinguish government taxes from airline service fees.

Intervention: Empowers the Government of India (GoI) to issue written directions on airline fares during extraordinary situations when intervention is necessary in the public interest.

About Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA):

Establishment – Established in 1927 as the Department of Civil Aviation (DoCA), it evolved into a statutory regulatory body under the Aircraft Amendment Act, 2020.

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- It is India's statutory regulatory body for civil aviation, functioning as an attached office under the MoCA.It oversees aviation safety, regulation and standardisation of air transport services operating to, from and within India.

Director General **(DG)**– Vir Vikram Yadav
Headquarters – New Delhi, Delhi

MoD Signs Rs. 53,866.50 Crore Contracts for Eight Next Generation Corvettes for Indian Navy

In November 2026, the Ministry of Defence **(MoD)** signed contracts worth **Rs. 53,866.50 Crore** with Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited **(GRSE)** and Goa Shipyard Limited **(GSL)** for the **construction of 8** Next Generation Corvettes **(NGCs)** for the Indian Navy (IN), to enhance the **IN's maritime capabilities** and promote indigenous warship manufacturing.

- The contracts were signed in the presence of **Rajesh Kumar Singh**, Secretary of MoD, at Kartavya Bhawan-2, New Delhi, Delhi.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Contracts worth Rs. 53,866.50 crore signed for 8 NGCs.
- ✓ **Signed By:** Ministry of Defence, GRSE and GSL.
- ✓ **Where?** Kartavya Bhawan-2, New Delhi, Delhi.
- ✓ **Purpose:** Strengthening maritime capabilities and indigenous warship manufacturing.
- ✓ **Construction Share:** GRSE – 5 corvettes; GSL – 3 corvettes.
- ✓ **Design:** IN; construction by competitively selected DPSUs.
- ✓ **Capabilities:** Advanced missiles, weapons and sensor suites; air, surface and sub-surface operations.
- ✓ **Timeline:** 10 years.

Highlights of the NGC Project for the Indian Navy:

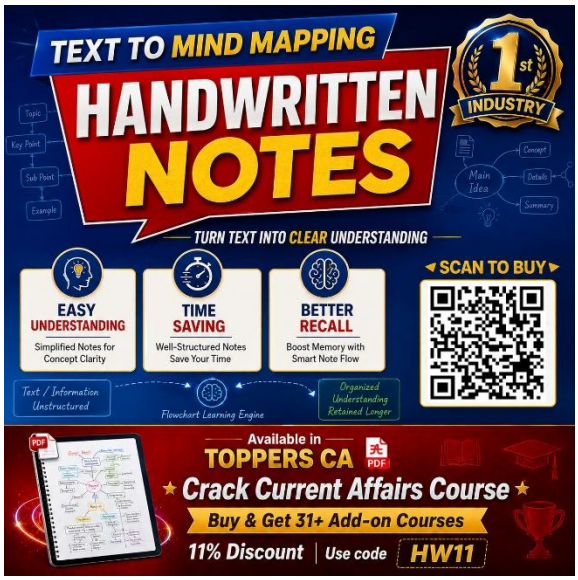
Shipbuilding: GRSE will construct **five corvettes**, while GSL will construct the remaining **three.**

Indigenous Design: The project marks the **1st project** in which warships will be indigenously designed by the IN and constructed by Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs) selected through a competitive process.

Capabilities: Equipped with **state-of-the-art capabilities** including advanced missiles, weapons and sensor suites, the NGCs will operate across air, surface and sub-surface domains, undertaking maritime trade route protection, anti-surface and anti-submarine warfare, coastal defence, littoral combat, maritime presence and surveillance missions.

Size and Displacement: The NGCs have a displacement of 3,800–4,000 tonnes, making them comparable in size to the IN's Talwar-class frigates.

Employment: The project is expected to generate approximately **72 lakh person**-days of employment in shipyards and **460 lakh** person-days in ancillary industries and Micro Small and Medium Enterprises **(MSMEs)** over the next **10 years.**



Ecosystem: The project will strengthen collaboration among DPSUs, private shipyards and Indian industrial partners, including MSMEs, while promoting the use of Made-in-India materials, equipment and indigenous technologies.

Significance: The project will strengthen India's indigenous warship design and construction capabilities and support the **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** and **Make in India** initiatives.

About Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL):

Overview: GSL is a premier Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs) and Schedule 'A' Mini Ratna Category-I company under the Ministry of Defence (MoD).
Chairman and Managing Director **(CMD)** – Brajesh Kumar Upadhyay
Administrative control – Ministry of Defence **(MoD)**
Headquarters – Vasco da Gama, Goa
Established – 1957

MoPR Signs MoU with CESL to Promote EV Infrastructure Across Panchayats

In October 2026, the Ministry of Panchayati Raj **(MoPR)** signed a Memorandum of Understanding **(MoU)** with Convergence Energy Services Limited **(CESL)** to develop Electric Vehicle **(EV) charging and battery swapping infrastructure** on Panchayat-owned land across India.

- The MoU was exchanged by Smt. Mukta Shekhar, Joint Secretary, MoPR andAkhilesh Kumar Dixit, Director of CESL during the National Workshop on People's Plan Campaign (PPC) 2026–27 in New Delhi, Delhi in the presence of Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh (Lalan Singh), MoPR.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** MoU signed
- ✓ **Entities:** MoPR and CESL
- ✓ **Signed By**: Mukta Shekhar (MoPR) and Akhilesh Kumar Dixit (CESL)
- ✓ **Purpose:** To develop EV charging and battery swapping stations
- ✓ **Coverage:** Gram, Block and District Panchayats across India.



Highlights of the MoU:

Focus: The initiative focuses on promoting rural clean mobility and strengthening the financial sustainability of Gram, Block and District Panchayats through additional Own Source Revenue **(OSR)** generation.
EV Infrastructure: The proposed facilities will support two-wheelers**(2W),** three-wheelers**(3W),** four-wheelers(**4W**), and medium and heavy-duty vehicles, expanding rural EV charging infrastructure.
Implementation: The MoPR will coordinate with State Panchayati Raj Departments to identify and monitor suitable sites, while CESL will handle site assessment, installation, commissioning, operation and maintenance of the EV facilities.
About CESL: Incorporated in 2020, CESL is a wholly owned subsidiary of Energy Efficiency Services Limited (EESL), under the Ministry of Power (MoP) headquartered in New Delhi.

Union MoS Dr Jitendra Singh Inaugurates 183rd Seismological Observatory in Kishtwar, J&K

In November 2026, Union Minister of State (MoS) (Independent Charge (IC)) **Dr. Jitendra Singh**, Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) inaugurated **183rd Seismological Observatory** in Kishtwar, Jammu & Kashmir (**J&K**) to transmit real-time seismic data to the National Centre for Seismology (**NCS**), New Delhi, Delhi to strengthen earthquake monitoring and disaster preparedness in the high seismic zone.

- With this, J&K now has **four** observatories, located in Jammu, Srinagar, Udhampur and Kishtwar.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Inauguration of India's 183rd Seismological Observator
- ✓ **Location:** Kishtwar, J & K

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- ✓ **Inaugurated By:** Union MoS (IC) Dr. Jitendra Singh, MoES
- ✓ **Data Centre:** 24×7 Earthquake Monitoring Centre, National Centre for Seismology, New Delhi
- ✓ **Earthquake Detection Target:** Magnitude 2.5 after the proposed expansion
- ✓ **Additional Infrastructure:** Four Doppler Weather Radars planned in J&K in 2027.

About Seismological Observatory at Kishtwar:

Features: The observatory uses advanced digital seismic equipment, replacing analogue systems, to monitor regional earthquake hazards, support emergency response and guide safer infrastructure planning in earthquake-prone areas.

Expansion Plans: The MoES plans to establish 100 additional Seismological Observatories, including 4 each in J&K and Ladakh, to improve earthquake detection from magnitude 3.0 to 2.5.

- Additionally, 4 Doppler Weather Radars (DWRs) will be commissioned in 2027 at Doda, Kishtwar, Anantnag and Baramulla in J&K.

Dissemination: MoES disseminates earthquake-related information through digital platforms, including the National Centre for Seismology (NCS) website, Bhookamp mobile application, Short Message Service (SMS) and email alerts, and social media platforms.

Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh Announces CoE for for Siri Cattle Conservation in Sikkim

In November 2026, Union Minister **Rajiv Ranjan Singh**, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying (MoFAH&D) and Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR), announced the establishment of a Centre of Excellence (**CoE**) for the conservation and development of Sikkim's indigenous **Siri cattle** breed.

- He also digitally launched the North District Cooperative Milk Producers' Union Ltd. (**NDMU**) under White Revolution 2.0 and initiated programmes to strengthen dairy development, livestock productivity and farmers' livelihoods.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** CoE for Siri cattle conservation and development announced
- ✓ **Announced By:** Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh, MoFAH&D and MoPR
- ✓ **State:** Sikkim
- ✓ **Key Technology:** In Vitro Fertilisation (IVF)
- ✓ **Other Initiative:** NDMU under White Revolution 2.0, Conservation Programme,Pig Breeding Protocols.

About CoE for Siri Cattle Conservation:

Framework: To conserve and develop the indigenous Siri cattle breed, using In Vitro Fertilisation (**IVF) technology** to accelerate genetic improvement and multiply superior germplasm.

Focus: A comprehensive plan will focus on breed improvement, genetic conservation, scientific breeding practices, preservation of indigenous genetic resources and the adoption of modern reproductive technologies.

Other Launches:

- **Conservation Programme:** Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh digitally launched the programme to preserve indigenous bovine genetic resources and promote sustainable livestock development.
- **Pig Breeding Protocols:** He launched a publication titled "Minimum Standard Protocol for Semen Production and Standard Operating Procedures for Artificial Insemination Using Liquid Semen in Pigs", aimed at improving scientific breeding and livestock productivity

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INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

Overview of COP17 to CBD Held from October 19 to 31, 2026 in Armenia

The 17th Conference of the Parties **(CoP17)** to the United Nations(UN) Convention on Biological Diversity **(CBD)** was held at the Meridian Expo and Event Centre in Yerevan, **Armenia,** under the theme "Taking Action for Nature."

- COP17, presided over by **Hambardzum Matevosyan**, the Minister of Environment of the Republic of Armenia, adopted nearly **50 decisions** to strengthen biodiversity conservation and implement the Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF).

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **Event:** CoP17 to CBD
- ✓ **Venue:** Yerevan, Armenia
- ✓ **2026 Theme: '**Taking Action for Nature'
- ✓ **COP17 President:** Hambardzum Matevosyan
- ✓ **India Represented By**: Union Minister Bhupender Yadav, MoEFCC
- ✓ **Key Outcomes:**
  - Adoption of Yerevan Pathway;
  - Announcement of nearly USD 2 billion in new biodiversity funding;
  - Adoption of nearly 50 new agenda items; among others
- ✓ **CoP18 to CBD:** Quito, Ecuador (in 2028).

About CBD COP17:

Aim: The two-week long conference brought together governments, international organisations, scientists, civil society, Indigenous people, youth and the private sector to examine progress, strengthen cooperation and accelerate action for biodiversity.

Logo: This year's conference logo was inspired by **"Polymmatus eriwanensis(Eriwan Blue)",** a butterfly species endemic to Armenia, featuring 23 colors, which correspond to the 23 action targets of the KMGBF.

Key Meetings: COP17 was held alongside the 12th Meeting of the Parties to the Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety (CP-MOP12) and the 6th Meeting of the Parties to the Nagoya Protocol (NP-MOP6).

Next Host: During the closing plenary session of the conference, Quito, the capital city of **Ecuador** has been selected to host the CoP18 to CBD in **2028.**

India at COP17 to CBD:

Indian Representation: Union Minister Bhupender Yadav, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC), led the Indian delegation at COP17 to CBD, reaffirming India's commitment to biodiversity conservation and highlighting its updated National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (NBSAP), comprising 23 national targets and 142 indicators.

- He highlighted India's 1,134 Protected Areas, 103 Ramsar sites, 57 Biodiversity Heritage Sites (BHS) and 18 Biosphere Reserves (BRs), including 13 under UNESCO's Man and the Biosphere (MAB) Network.

Key Releases: During a side event titled **"From Policy to Practice: Advancing India's Biodiversity Commitments through Innovation, Finance, ABS and OECMS"** organised by the MoEFCC in partnership with India's National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) and United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), India released the **4** key publications.

- Guidelines for the Designation of India's Other Effective Area-Based Conservation Measures (I-OECMs) 2026; 5th National Report on Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety; The Convention on Biological Diversity Handbook: Reference Guide and Indian Perspective; and India's Access and Benefit Sharing (ABS) Success Story.

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Key Outcomes:

Yerevan Pathway: One of the key outcomes of the conference was unanimous adoption of Yerevan Pathway, a negotiated response to the first review of collective progress in the implementation of the KMGBF.

- The newly adopted pathway identifies priorities to accelerate the implementation of KMBGF until 2030, including tackling nature-harmful subsidies and incentives, increasing financial, scientific and technical support for developing countries, aligning national budgets and economic decisions with the KMGBF, and strengthening implementation, monitoring, reporting and review mechanisms.

Biodiversity Funding Commitment: Under the Global Biodiversity Framework (GBF), member nations had pledged to raise at least USD 200 billion annually from all sources by 2030, including global biodiversity finance from developed to developing countries to at least USD 30 billion by 2030.

- In addition, the conference announced approximately **USD 2 billion** in new biodiversity funding and financial commitments, including USD 560 million under the 9th replenishment of the Global Environment Facility (GEF) and its GBF fund; USD 500 million through the Species Recovery Alliance and over USD 330 million through the Value Nature Fund.

Adoption of 50 Agenda Items: Also, the conference adopted **around 50** agenda items focused on: protected areas and forest biodiversity, sustainable wildlife management, invasive alien species, risk assessment of living modified organisms, marine and coastal biodiversity, synthetic biology, and biodiversity mainstreaming.

Other Key Outcomes: Some of the other outcomes of the conference were: the **Sevan Guidelines** (for the establishment of new permanent subsidiary body on Article 8(j)); launch of a new biodiversity bond and investment incubator; and a proposal for model framework law on forests to strengthen environmental enforcement was discussed.

About CoP to CBD:

Background: CoP to the CBD is an apex governing body of the international treaty, adopted in 1992, for the conservation of biodiversity, the sustainable use of components of biodiversity, and equitable sharing of the benefits from the use of genetic resources.

Biennial Event: The members of the CoP to the CBD meet every two years (biennially) to review the progress of the convention.

- The CoP16 to the CBD was conducted in Cali, Colombia, which was paused due to lack of quorum required for biodiversity finance related agreements.
- Later, the conference (COP16.2) to CBD was resumed, held from February 25 to 27, 2025 at the headquarters of Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO) in Rome, Italy.

Members: At present, CBD comprises **196** member countries including India.

Key Protocol: KMGBF was established during COP15 held in Montreal, Canada in 2022, managed by the Global Environment Facility (GEF).

- Currently, it is operational and received initial funding from Austria, Canada, Denmark, France, Germany, among others, which amounted to nearly USD 382 million.

About Armenia:

President- Vahagn Khachaturyan
Capital- Yerevan
Currency- Armenian Dram (AMD)

Overview of 20th ADMM and 13th ADMM-Plus 2026 Held in Cebu, Philippines

The **20th** Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) Defence Ministers' Meeting (**ADMM**) and **13th ADMM-Plus** were held on **28 and 29 October 2026,** respectively, under the ASEAN 2026 theme "**Navigating Our Future, Together**" at the Mactan Expo Center in **Cebu, the Philippines.**

- The meetings brought together ASEAN defence ministers and eight dialogue partners to strengthen regional defence and security cooperation.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** 20th ADMM and 13th ADMM-Plus 2026
- ✓ **Hosted by:** The Philippines
- ✓ **Dates:** 28–29 October 2026
- ✓ **Chaired by:** Gilberto C. Teodoro Jr., Secretary of DND of the Philippines.
- ✓ **Indian Representation:** Union Minister Rajnath Singh, MoD
- ✓ **India's Proposal:** India–ASEAN Youth Bridge
- ✓ **Next Chair (2027):** Singapore Defence Minister Chan Chun Sing

Key Highlights:

Chairmanship: The meetings were chaired by Gilberto C. Teodoro Jr., Secretary of the Department of National Defense (DND), Philippines.

Indian Representation: Union Minister Rajnath Singh, Ministry of Defence (MoD), represented India and proposed establishing an India–ASEAN Youth Bridge to promote people-to-people connectivity, digital innovation and capacity building in defence cooperation.

India co-chairs EWG on Counter-terrorism: India and Malaysia co-chaired the ADMM-Plus Experts' Working Group (EWG) on Counter-Terrorism for the 2024–2027 cycle, with India reaffirming its commitment to regional security and sharing counter-terrorism expertise.

Key Outcome: ASEAN defence ministers issued a Joint Statement on Youth, Peace and Security, commemorating the 50th anniversary of the Treaty of Amity and Cooperation (TAC) in Southeast Asia.

Next Host for ADMM and ADMM-Plus: The Philippines handed over the chairmanship of the 21st ADMM and 14th ADMM-Plus (2027) to Singapore, represented by Defence Minister Chan Chun Sing.

About Association of South East Asian Nations (ASEAN):

Formation: Established on 8 August 1967 through the Bangkok Declaration signed by Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore and Thailand.

Member Nations:11 countries, including Timor-Leste, which joined in 2025.

Dialogue Partners: Australia, China, India, Japan, New Zealand, Republic of Korea, Russia and the United States of America (USA).

Secretary-General- Dr. Kao Kim Hourn

Secretariat- South Jakarta, Indonesia

BANKING & FINANCE

SEBI Issues Framework To Issue DRs of REITs and InvITs at GIFT City, Reduces OFS Cooling-off period

In November 2026, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (**SEBI**) issued frameworks allowing Real Estate Investment Trusts **(REITs)** and Infrastructure Investment Trusts **(InvITs)**, to issue Depository Receipts (**DRs**) backed by their units and list them on exchanges at the Gujarat International Finance Tec-City **(GIFT City),** Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

- The SEBI also reduced the Offer for Sale (OFS) cooling-off period from twelve weeks to **eight weeks** for illiquid private listed InvITs.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** SEBI issues framework to allow REITs and InvITs to issue DRs
- ✓ **DR Listing Venue:** GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat
- ✓ **Permitted Exchange:** India INX, NSE IX
- ✓ **Unitholders Approval:** 75% of total votes cast in favour of resolution
- ✓ **Restriction:** Indian Residents barred
- ✓ **Cooling Off Period:** Reduced from 12 weeks to 8 weeks
- ✓ **Applicability:** Illiquid privately listed InvITs
- ✓ **OFS Duration:** One trading day.

REITs and InvITs DRs Issuance:

Depository Receipts: DRs are foreign currency-denominated instruments issued by a foreign depository against underlying units deposited with a domestic custodian.

Permitted Exchanges: The permitted exchanges are:

- India International Exchange (**India INX**)
- National Stock Exchange International Exchange (**NSE IX)**

Unitholders Approval: Fresh issuance of DRs will require prior approval from unitholders, with at least **75%** of the total votes cast in favour of resolution.

- Approval not required when REIT or InvIT undertakes an initial offer of units and simultaneously issues DRs.

Tender: If existing unitholders transfer their units for the purpose of issuing and listing DRs, the REIT or InvIT must provide an opportunity to all existing unitholders to tender and participate in the offering.

Restriction: The framework bars Indian residents from holding DRs, including through beneficial ownership.

- Responsibility for ensuring compliance with this condition will lie with the DR holders and their beneficial owners.

Eligibility Requirements: REITs, InvITs, their directors, promoters and partners, and unitholders transferring units must not be debarred by SEBI, wilful defaulters or fugitive economic offenders.

- They must also not be associated as promoters or directors with any entity debarred from accessing the capital market.
- These restrictions do not apply if the debarment period has expired by the date of filing the relevant offer document.

Disclosure & Investor Eligibility: International disclosures must be filed with Indian exchanges within **24 hours,** while DRs of privately placed InvITs are restricted to foreign institutional investors and corporate bodies, subject to applicable regulations.

Merchant Banker (MB): The manager of a REIT and the investment manager of an InvIT will have to appoint a MB to oversee compliance with the DR issuance requirements.

Fresh Issue: For a fresh issue, the initial offer document must be filed with SEBI and the stock exchanges through the merchant banker.

Cooling Off Period Reduced:

Cooling Off Period: A cooling-off period is a mandatory waiting period before an investor or existing unitholder can sell units through an OFS.

Change: The SEBI has reduced the cooling-off period for Offer for Sale (**OFS**) of units of illiquid private listed **InvITs** to **8 weeks** from **12 weeks** earlier.

Liquidity Challenge: Privately listed InvITs generally face liquidity constraints due to their high trading lot sizes, which limit participation largely to institutional investors, corporates and high-net-worth individuals. Consequently, their trading volumes tend to remain low.

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Exemption: SEBI clarified that retail investor-related provisions under the general OFS framework will not apply to private listed InvITs.

About DR Framework

Regulatory Basis: The new DR framework operates under the Depository Receipts Scheme, 2014, and the Foreign Exchange Management (Non-debt Instruments) Rules, 2019.

SEBI Regulations: The framework is supported by the SEBI (Real Estate Investment Trusts) Regulations, 2014, and SEBI (Infrastructure Investment Trusts) Regulations, 2014.

Key Terms:

Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs): Investment vehicles that pool funds from investors to own and manage income-generating real estate assets, such as commercial offices, shopping malls and warehouses, providing returns mainly through rental income.

Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs): Investment vehicles that pool funds from investors to invest in income-generating infrastructure assets, such as roads, power transmission lines and pipelines, providing returns through project-generated income.

Fibe Launches UPI Payments Segment after NPCI Grants TPAP Approval

In November 2026, **Fibe** (formerly known as EarlySalary), digital lending platform, launched Unified Payments Interface (UPI) payments on its application (app) after receiving the Third-Party Application Provider **(TPAP)** approval from the National Payments Corporation of India **(NPCI).**

- TPAP authorization will now enable the company to offer UPI payments directly through its own app.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Launches UPI Payment services on its app
- ✓ **Who?** Fibe
- ✓ **Launches After:** NPCI Grants TPAP Approval
- ✓ **Available for:** All consumers across India, including non-Fibe consumers
- ✓ **Key Payment Services:** Bank accounts; RuPaY credit cards, and eligible credit lines linked to UPI.

About Fibe's UPI Payment Services:

Applicability: With the approval, consumers across India (including those who do not borrow from Fibe) can now avail the UPI service.

Key Offerings: Through the new service, the users can now pay from their bank accounts; use RuPay credit cards; tag eligible credit lines linked to UPI ; and join without being a borrower.

TPAP: It is a non-bank entity authorised by NPCI to offer UPI payment services through its application in partnership with Payment Service Provider (PSP) banks.

About Fibe: The company was initially established with the brand name EarlySalary in 2015 and was later renamed as "Fibe" in 2022. It is headquartered in Pune, Maharashtra.

Razorpay Receives Final PSP Licence from IFSCA to Operate from GIFT City

In November 2026, **Razorpay Payments Private Limited** received the final Payment Service Provider **(PSP) licence** from the International Financial Services Centres Authority **(IFSCA)** to operate from Gujarat International Finance Tec-City **(GIFT City),** Gandhinagar (Gujarat).

- Prior to receiving the final authorization, the fintech company secured the in-principle approval in April 2026.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Razorpay Receives Final PSP Licence
- ✓ **Granted by:** IFSCA
- ✓ **Operate from:** GIFT City (Gandhinagar, Gujarat)

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- ✓ **Purpose:** Cross-Border Payments and Global Investment Services
- ✓ **Banking Partners:** RBL Bank and ICICI Bank

Key Details:

Significance: The licence will enable the company to support international collections, settlements, global investments and multi-currency transactions through its GIFT City-based infrastructure.

- In addition, the company will enable Indian investment and wealth platforms to offer overseas equities through a single compliant infrastructure, in line with Foreign Exchange Management Act **(FEMA)** and GIFT City regulations.

Banking Partners: Razorpay's banking integrations with **RBL Bank Limited** and **ICICI Bank Limited** are already live on the network. The company further plans to add more banking partners in the coming months.

Existing RBI Approvals: Razorpay also holds approvals from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for online, offline and cross-border payment services.

About Razorpay: Founded in 2014 and headquartered in Bengaluru, Karnataka, Razorpay is an Indian financial technology (fintech) company providing digital payments, payment processing and business financial solutions.

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

Ministry of Coal Presents Star Rating Awards for FY25, Recognising 50 Five-Star Coal and Lignite Mines in Raipur, Chhattisgarh

On 2 November 2026, the **Ministry of Coal** organised the **Annual Star Rating Awards Ceremony** in Raipur, Chhattisgarh, recognising excellence in coal and lignite mining, with **50 mines** receiving **Five-Star Ratings** for Financial Year 2024–25 **(FY25),** including **10 top-performing mines** securing first, second and third positions with scores exceeding **93%**.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Annual Star Rating Awards Ceremony for coal and lignite mines
- ✓ **Organised By:** Ministry of Coal
- ✓ **Where?** Raipur, Chhattisgarh
- ✓ **Assessment Year:** FY25
- ✓ **Five-Star Mines:** 50 coal mines
- ✓ **Top Performers:** 10 mines secured top positions with scores exceeding 93%
- ✓ **Opencast Category:** NCL & NTPC secured First Prize
- ✓ **Underground Category:** SCCL secured First Prize.
- ✓ **Special Appreciation:** WCL for the highest number of Five-Star Rated mines among Coal India subsidiaries
- ✓ **Policy Authority:** CCO.

Highlights of the Ceremony:

Participation: Union Minister of State(MoS) Satish Chandra Dubey, Ministry of Coal and Ministry of Mines (MoM) attended the ceremony alongside senior Ministry officials, representatives of Coal India Limited (CIL) and its subsidiaries, NLC India Limited (NLC), Singareni Collieries Company Limited (SCCL), and other coal industry stakeholders.

Assessment: The Ministry of Coal annually evaluates mines on **84 parameters** covering operational performance, safety, management, infrastructure, environmental protection and workers' welfare, with scores above 91 out of 100 qualifying for a Five-Star Rating.

Recognition: The awards recognise mines demonstrating excellence in operational efficiency,

environmental sustainability, occupational health and safety, technological advancement, responsible resource management and workers' welfare.

About Five-Star Ratings:

About Star Rating Policy: Assesses coal and lignite mines on operational efficiency, technology, safety, environmental management, sustainability, rehabilitation and resettlement, and community welfare.

- Mines receive ratings from five stars to no star after assessment and validation by reviewers appointed by the Coal Controller's Organisation (CCO).

Opencast: Northern Coalfields Limited **(NCL)** and National Thermal Power Corporation (**NTPC)** secured the First Prize in the Opencast category.

Underground: Singareni Collieries Company Limited (SCCL) secured the First Prize in the Underground category, with Union Minister Satish Chandra Dubey presenting the award to SCCL Chairman and Managing Director (MD) Buddhaprakash Jyoti.

- The five award-winning mines were RKNT and RK-6 Incline in Srirampur Area, JVR OC-2 in Sattupalli Area, Khairigura OC in Bellampalli Area, and RGOC-1 in Ramagundam-3 Area.

Appreciation: Western Coalfields Limited (WCL) received special appreciation for recording the highest number of Five-Star Rated mines among Coal India subsidiaries.

Performance: Northern Coalfields Limited (NCL) and Mahanadi Coalfields Limited (MCL) were appreciated for consistently maintaining high performance in Star Rating evaluations and production.

Hackathon:

Recognition: During the event, winners and runners-up of the Hackathon on R&D 2026, jointly organised by the Central Mine Planning and Design Institute (CMPDI), a subsidiary of Coal India Limited, and the Ministry of Coal, were recognised for innovative solutions under the theme "NextGen AI for Smart Mining," focusing on operational efficiency, mine safety and environmental sustainability.

Winners: Recognised participants included Council of Scientific and Industrial Research–National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI), Nagpur; Technowave Solutions Private Limited, Ranchi, with Indian Institute of Technology (Indian School of Mines), Dhanbad, Jharkhand; and CSIR–Central Leather Research Institute (CSIR-CLRI), Chennai, Tamil Nadu (TN), with Dr Kalyan Sen & Associates Pvt. Ltd., Kolkata, West Bengal (WB).

Consortium: A consortium comprising CSIR–Central Mechanical Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-CMERI), Durgapur, WB; Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala; and M/s Unurashapa Corporation Lord Tech, Ranchi, Jharkhand, was also among the winners.

Prizes: Winners of each topic will receive cash prizes of Rs. 4 lakh, Rs. 3 lakh and Rs. 2 lakh for the first, second and third positions, respectively, along with mementos and certificates.

About Ministry of Coal:

Union Minister– Gangapuram (G.) Kishan Reddy (Constituency- Secunderabad, Telangana)
Minister of State **(MoS)**– Satish Chandra Dubey (Rajya Sabha – Bihar)

Note: Both ministers also hold ministerial responsibilities in the Ministry of Mines (MoM).

ACQUISITIONS & MERGERS

CCI Approves Five Major Deals Across Food, Energy, Power, Fintech and Telecom Sectors

In October 2026, the Competition Commission of India **(CCI)** approved **five major proposed transactions** across the **food services**, renewable energy **(RE)**, **power infrastructure**, **financial services** and **telecommunications** sectors.

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- The approvals cover mergers and acquisitions involving Indian and international companies, including Devyani International, Sapphire Foods, Aditya Birla Renewables, Adani Energy Solutions, Prosus and Vodafone Group.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** CCI approved five major proposed mergers and acquisition transactions.
- ✓ **Proposed mergers and acquisition:** Food services, renewable energy, power infrastructure, financial services and telecommunications
- ✓ **Food:** Sapphire Foods–Devyani International merger.
- ✓ **RE:** Aditya Birla Renewables to acquire Solenergi Power from Shell.
- ✓ **Power:** Adani Energy Solutions to acquire IntelliSmart Infrastructure.
- ✓ **Finance:** Prosus subsidiary MIH Payments to acquire a stake in Navi.
- ✓ **Telecom:** France's Vega SAS to acquire a 16.2% stake in Vodafone.

Highlights of the Five Approved Transactions:

Food Services: CCI approved the merger of Sapphire Foods India Limited with Devyani International Limited, combining their Kentucky Fried Chicken (KFC) and Pizza Hut businesses.

- **Scale:** Over **3,000 global stores** and approximately **Rs. 8,000 crore** annualised turnover.

Renewable Energy: CCI cleared Aditya Birla Renewables Limited's proposed acquisition of 100% of Solenergi Power Private Limited from Shell Overseas Investment B.V.

- **Investment:** Approximately **Rs. 17,200 crore**, including Shell's Sprng Energy business in India.

Power Infrastructure: CCI approved Adani Energy Solutions Limited's proposed acquisition of 100% of IntelliSmart Infrastructure Private Limited for Rs. 3,050 crore from the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF) and Energy Efficiency Services Limited (EESL).

- The acquisition is expected to strengthen Adani Energy Solutions' presence in India's smart electricity metering sector.

Financial Services: CCI approved acquisition of a certain shareholding by MIH Payments Holdings B.V., an indirect wholly owned subsidiary of Prosus N.V. in Navi Limited, founded by Sachin Bansal.

Telecommunications: French company Vega SAS received approval to acquire a **16.2% stake** in Vodafone Group PLC, which operates telecommunications businesses across Europe and Africa and has a presence in India through Vodafone Idea Limited.

About the Competition Commission of India (CCI):

Overview: The Competition Commission of India (CCI) is a statutory body established under the Competition Act, 2002, to promote fair competition and prevent anti-competitive practices in the Indian market.

- It works under the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) and regulates mergers, acquisitions and combinations that may adversely affect competition.

Recommendation: The Raghavan Committee, headed by S.V. Raghavan, recommended the establishment of the CCI in its 2000 report, leading to the Competition Act, 2002.

Chairperson: Ravneet Kaur

Headquarters: New Delhi, Delhi

Established: 14 October 2003

SPORTS

Mexico City Grand Prix 2026: Verstappen Wins, Antonelli Clinches Maiden Title

In November 2026, **Max Verstappen**, a Dutch Formula One (**F1**) driver representing Red Bull Racing, won the **2026 Mexico City** Grand Prix (**GP**), the **19th** round of the 2026 F1 World Championship (23 total

rounds), held on 1 November 2026 at the Autódromo Hermanos Rodríguez in Mexico City, Mexico.

- The 2026 Mexico City GP marked the **26th edition** of the race and the **sixth** held under the name Mexico City Grand Prix.
- **Andrea Kimi Antonelli** of Italy, representing Mercedes, clinched his **maiden F1 World Drivers' Championship** at **20 years and 68 days**, becoming the youngest-ever champion with 380 points despite finishing third in the race, breaking Sebastian Vettel's previous record of 23 years and 134 days, set in 2010.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Mexico City Grand Prix 2026
- ✓ **When?** 1 November 2026
- ✓ **Where?** Autódromo Hermanos Rodríguez, Mexico City, Mexico
- ✓ **Edition:** 19th round of the 2026 F1 season
- ✓ **Winner:** Max Verstappen (Red Bull Racing)
- ✓ **Podium:** Lewis Hamilton (Ferrari, 2nd), Andrea Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes, 3rd)
- ✓ **Achievement:** Kimi Antonelli, clinched maiden F1 World Drivers' Champion, became youngest-ever at 20 years and 68 days.

About Mexico City Grand Prix 2026:

Performance: Max Verstappen finished 0.799 seconds ahead of Lewis Hamilton of Scuderia Ferrari with a race time of 2:20:28.772.

Podium: Lewis Hamilton of Scuderia Ferrari finished second and Andrea Kimi Antonelli of Mercedes AMG Petronas F1 finished third.

Milestone: Antonelli became the third Italian driver to win the F1 World Drivers' Championship, after Giuseppe Farina and Alberto Ascari, ending Italy's 73-year wait since Ascari's 1953 title.

Retirements: Five drivers retired from the race: Valtteri Bottas (Cadillac) due to suspension failure, Arvid Lindblad (Racing Bulls) following a collision, Oliver Bearman (Haas) due to contact damage, and Lance Stroll and Fernando Alonso (Aston Martin).

Top 3 positions of F1 Mexico City Grand Prix 2026

Rank	Driver	Brand	Country
1	Max Verstappen	Red Bull Racing	Netherlands
2	Lewis Hamilton	Ferrari	United Kingdom (UK)
3	Andrea Kimi Antonelli	Mercedes AMG Petronas F1	Italy

Top 5 Drivers – Championship Standings After Mexico City Grand Prix 2026

Rank	Driver	Team	Points
1	Kimi Antonelli	Mercedes AMG Petronas F1	380
2	Max Verstappen	Red Bull Racing	261
3	Lewis Hamilton	Scuderia Ferrari HP	259
4	George Russell	Mercedes AMG Petronas F1	250

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5	Charles Leclerc	Scuderia Ferrari HP	245

About Mexico City Grand Prix:

Overview: The 2026 Mexico City Grand Prix was held over **71 laps**, with the inaugural edition taking place in 1963, won by Jim Clark.

Circuit Specifications: The Mexico City GP is held on a permanent motor racing circuit measuring 4.304 km (Kilometres), with a total race distance of 305.354 km.

Indian shuttlers Lakshya Sen and PV Sindhu Win Singles Titles at HYLO Open 2026 in Germany

Indian shuttlers **Lakshya Sen** and **P. V. Sindhu** won the **men's and women's singles titles**, respectively, at the Hylo Open 2026, a Badminton World Federation **(BWF) Super 500 tournament** held in Saarbrücken, Germany, on 27 October – 1 November 2026, with straight-game victories in their finals.

- Second-seeded Sindhu defeated Denmark's eighth-seeded and world No. 25 **Line Højmark Kjærsfeldt** 21–12, 21–14, while seventh-seeded Sen defeated defending champion and world No. 6 **Jonatan Christie** of Indonesia 21–17, 21–10, with both finals lasting 39 minutes.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Hylo Open 2026 badminton tournament
- ✓ **Host City:** Saarbrucken, Germany
- ✓ **When?** 27 October – 1 November 2026
- ✓ **Tournament Category:** BWF Super 500
- ✓ **Men's Singles Winner:** Lakshya Sen (India) Defeated Jonatan Christie (Indonesia)
- ✓ **Women's Singles Winner:** PV Sindhu (India) Defeated Line Kjærsfeldt (Denmark)
- ✓ **Prize Money:** Total USD 500,000

About Hylo Open 2026:

Singles: P. V. Sindhu became the **first Indian woman** to win the Hylo Open women's singles title, securing her second BWF World Tour title of the season and increasing her career tally to seven.

- Lakshya Sen claimed his second men's singles title (after 2019), becoming the **first Indian** to win the Hylo Open men's singles title twice and earning his first BWF World Tour title of 2026.

Doubles: Christian Faust Kjær and Rasmus Kjær (Denmark) won the men's doubles title, defeating Ben Lane and Sean Vendy (England), while Amallia Cahaya Pratiwi and Siti Fadia Silva Ramadhanti (Indonesia) claimed the women's doubles title against Hsu Yin-Hui and Lin Jhih Yun (Chinese Taipei).

- In mixed doubles, Thom Gicquel and Delphine Delrue (France) defeated Jesper Toft and Amalie Magelund (Denmark) to secure the title.

Prize money: The tournament featured a total prize pool of USD 500,000, with the singles champion receiving USD 37,500 and the doubles champion receiving USD 39,500.

Winners at Hylo Open 2026:

Category	Winner(s)	Runner(s)-up
Men's Singles	Lakshya Sen (India)	Jonatan Christie (Indonesia)
Women's Singles	P. V. Sindhu (India)	Line Højmark Kjærsfeldt (Denmark)
Men's Doubles	Christian Faust Kjær / Rasmus Kjær (Denmark)	Ben Lane / Sean Vendy (England)

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Women's Doubles	Amallia Cahaya Pratiwi / Siti Fadia Silva Ramadhanti (Indonesia)	Hsu Yin-Hui / Lin Jhih Yun (Chinese Taipei)
Mixed Doubles	Thom Gicquel / Delphine Delrue (France)	Jesper Toft / Amalie Cecilie Kudsk (Denmark)

About Badminton World Federation (BWF):

President – Khunying Patama Leeswadtrakul
Headquarters – Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
Established – 1934

Australian All-Rounder Glenn Maxwell Retires from International Cricket After 14-Year Career

In November 2026, **Australian all-rounder Glenn Maxwell** announced his retirement from **international cricket**, concluding a 14-year career with his final international appearance coming against Oman in Australia's concluding match of the International Cricket Council (ICC) Men's Twenty20 (T20) World Cup 2026 in February 2026.

- Maxwell, who retired from One-Day International (ODI) cricket in June 2025, also retired from first-class and List A cricket but will continue playing franchise T20 cricket for Melbourne Stars in the Big Bash League (BBL).

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Retirement announcement from international cricket
- ✓ **Who?** Glenn Maxwell, Australian all-rounder
- ✓ **Career Duration:** 14 years
- ✓ **Matches played:** 149 ODI, 130 T20I, 7 Tests
- ✓ **World Cup Titles:** 2015, 2023 ODI World Cups; 2021 T20 World Cup
- ✓ **Future Plans:** Continue playing franchise T20 cricket, including for Melbourne Stars in the BBL.

About Glenn Maxwell:

Statistics: Maxwell represented Australia in 149 ODIs, scoring 3,990 runs at a strike rate of 126.7, and 130 Twenty20 Internationals (T20Is), scoring 2,897 runs at a strike rate of 154.42, claiming 51 wickets and 5 centuries, including a highest score of 145 not out against Sri Lanka in 2016, jointly holding the record for most T20I centuries with India's Rohit Sharma.

- In 7 Test matches, he scored 339 runs, with a highest score of 104 against India in Ranchi in 2017, taking his overall international tally to 10 centuries and 136 wickets.

World Cups: He won two ICC Men's Cricket World Cups (2015 and 2023) and the ICC Men's T20 World Cup (2021), scoring the winning runs in the 2021 final against New Zealand and an unbeaten 201 against Afghanistan in the 2023 ODI World Cup while chasing 292 runs and rescuing Australia from 91/7.
Titles: Maxwell won four Sheffield Shield titles (2014–15, 2015–16, 2016–17 and 2018–19), the County Championship (2015), the Indian Premier League (IPL) title (2013) and Major League Cricket (MLC) title (2024).
Awards: He received Cricket Australia's Men's One-Day International Player of the Year award (2016), Twenty20 International Player of the Year awards (2016 and 2019), and Big Bash League Player of the Series award (2024–25).

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OBITUARY

Eminent Neurosurgeon and Padma Shri Awardee Dr. Ashok Kumar Mahapatra Passed Away at 74

In November 2026, eminent neurosurgeon and Padma Shri awardee Professor **Dr. Ashok Kumar Mahapatra** passed away in New Delhi, Delhi at the age of 74. He was born on 29 December 1952 in Puri, Odisha.

- He was conferred the **Padma Shri**, India's fourth-highest civilian award in **2025** in the field of medicine.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Eminent neurosurgeon and Padma Shri awardee Passed away
- ✓ **Who?** Dr. Ashok Kumar Mahapatra
- ✓ **Award:** Padma Shri (2025), C. V. Raman Award (2021)
- ✓ **Known For:** Led the 2017 surgery separating conjoined twins Jaga and Kalia
- ✓ **Key Position**: Founding Director of AIIMS Bhubaneswar.

About Dr. Ashok Kumar Mahapatra:

Profile: He was an eminent neurosurgeon and academician who made significant contributions to neurosurgery and healthcare administration.

Career: He headed the Department of Neurosurgery at All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi and served as the founding Director of AIIMS Bhubaneswar, Odisha (2012–2016) and Director of Sanjay Gandhi Postgraduate Institute of Medical Sciences (SGPGIMS), Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh (UP) (2006–2009).

- He also served as Vice-Chancellor of Siksha 'O' Anusandhan (SOA) University, Bhubaneswar, Odisha (2020–2022), and later as its medical advisor.

Medical Organisations: He was the founding President of the Neurological Surgeons Society of India (NSSI) and the Indian Society of Peripheral Nerve Surgery (ISPNS), both established in 2011.

Landmark Surgery: In 2017, he led a multidisciplinary team at AIIMS, New Delhi, Delhi in a historic **16-hour operation** to separate conjoined craniopagus twins, **Jaga** and **Balia**, from Odisha. Both children survived the surgery, which was considered the first of its kind in India.

Research: He contributed to neurosurgical research through scientific publications, books and academic chapters.

- He authored approximately **870 research papers**, **16 books** and over 140 book chapters, receiving more than 26,800 citations.

Awards: He received the **C. V. Raman Award for Scientific Excellence** (2022), in recognition of his outstanding contributions to scientific research and excellence in the field of medical science.

IMPORTANT DAYS

International Day for Biosphere Reserves 2026 – November 3

The United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization **(UNESCO)** observes the International Day for Biosphere Reserves (BR) or World Biosphere Reserve Day globally every year on **3 November** to promote biodiversity conservation and sustainable development.

- November 3, 2026 marks the observance of the **5th** International Day for BR.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** International Day for Biosphere Reserves 2026

- ✓ **2026 Edition:** 5th
- ✓ **Purpose:** To promote biodiversity conservation, sustainable development and harmony between humans and nature
- ✓ **Observed by:** UNESCO
- ✓ **First Observed:** 3 November 2022
- ✓ **Global WNBR:** 797 BR across 145 countries
- ✓ **India's BR:** 18 BRs (13 under UNESCO's WNBR).

Background:

Proposal: At the request of **Spain and Uruguay,** the UNESCO Executive Board, at its 211th session, recommended proclaiming 3 November as the International Day for BR.

Proclamation: In **2021,** the 41st session of the UNESCO General Conference adopted **Resolution 41 C/37,** officially proclaiming 3 November as the International Day for Biosphere Reserves.

First Observance: The first observance took place on **3 November 2022.**

About Biosphere Reserves (BRs):

BR: Nationally designated areas recognised under UNESCO's Man and the Biosphere **(MAB) Programme** for biodiversity conservation and sustainable development, while remaining under national jurisdiction.

MAB Programme: UNESCO launched the MAB Programme in 1971 to strengthen the relationship between people and their environment through scientific research and sustainable development.

Governing Body: The MAB Programme is governed by the International Coordinating Council **(MAB-ICC),** comprising 34 UNESCO Member States.

Global Coverage: The World Network of Biosphere Reserves (WNBR) comprises **797** sites across **145** countries as of 2026.

- These reserves span approximately **7.5 million square kilometres** (sq km), accounting for over 5% of Earth's land surface.

Climate Risk: BR cover approximately **5% of Earth's terrestrial surface**, support over **60%** of terrestrial vertebrate species richness and are home to around **300 million** people; nearly 40% may face more extreme climate events by **2050.**

Biosphere Reserves in India:

National Coverage: India has 18 notified BRs covering approximately 91,425 square kilometres (sq. km), of which 13 are recognised under UNESCO's World Network of Biosphere Reserves (WNBR), the **highest number in South Asia**.

First BR: Designated in 1986, the Nilgiri BR was India's first, spanning Tamil Nadu (TN), Kerala and Karnataka.

Latest Inclusion: In September 2025, UNESCO included Himachal Pradesh's (HP) **Cold Desert BR** in the WNBR, taking India's total to **13** recognised reserves.

Administration and Funding: The MoEFCC implements the Biodiversity Conservation Scheme under the Conservation of Natural Resources and Ecosystems **(CNRE)** Programme through State Forest Departments, with **Centre–State** funding shared at **60:40** (**90:10** for North-Eastern and Himalayan States).

India's Conservation and Biodiversity: Since 2022–23, MoEFCC has piloted five-year Integrated Management Plans in four BR: Nanda Devi (Uttarakhand), Pachmarhi (Madhya Pradesh, MP), Dehang-Dibang (Arunachal Pradesh, AR) and Agasthyamalai (Kerala–Tamil Nadu, TN).

- Despite occupying only 2.4% of the Earth's land area, India accounts for approximately 7–8% of recorded global species.

About Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC):

Union Minister– Bhupender Yadav (Constituency -Alwar, Rajasthan)

Minister of State **(MoS)**– Kirtivardhan Singh (Constituency- Gonda, Uttar Pradesh UP)

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